

Hector Rodriguez Valdes

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Digital Transformation & Education Strategy Lead | AI, Automation and Student-Facing Digital Innovation | Founder, *Quezzi*

Professional Summary

Digital transformation and education strategy leader with 10+ years of experience translating emerging technology, education needs, and organisational priorities into practical change. Strong record of linking strategy with delivery across academic, professional, compliance, and technology-adjacent teams, with experience spanning AI adoption, business process automation, digital learning platforms, and assessment redesign. Postgraduate research background in applied ethics and ethics of emerging technology supports balanced decision-making across innovation, risk, and privacy.

Targeted Value for Digital Transformation Strategist

Education-facing digital innovation	Designing technology-enabled improvements that support learners, teachers, and institutional quality across teaching, assessment, and student experience.
Business process improvement and automation	Workflow redesign and AI-enabled automation to eliminate manual bottlenecks and improve productivity at scale.
Linking strategy with delivery	Translating strategic priorities and emerging trends into practical frameworks, operating models, training, and implementation pathways.
Stakeholder engagement and influence	Facilitation, consultation, and change communication across academic, professional, compliance, and senior leadership groups, including Pro Vice-Chancellor level.
Responsible emerging technology adoption	AI governance, ethics, risk management, privacy, and quality assurance, grounded in postgraduate research in ethics of emerging technologies.

Selected Achievements

- Led the pilot implementation of a new enterprise LMS (Brightspace), with outcomes shaping the university-wide rollout strategy.
- Created AI-era assessment integrity frameworks now adopted as the standard across all School course offerings.
- Introduced automation into the setup of 30+ subjects running six times per year, significantly reducing workload allocation and generating estimated annual savings exceeding \$200K.
- Founded Quezzi, an AI-powered SMS platform, taking it from concept to live product with paying subscribers across three international markets.
- Delivered 10+ nationally funded (NPILF) digital capability subjects under Study Link, broadening STEM participation and digital skills pathways in regional Australia.
- Elected to the Charles Sturt University Academic Senate.

Platforms, Tools, and Methods

- AI and integration: OpenAI (GPT models, API), Anthropic Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Google APIs, Cogniti AI learning platform.
- Education platforms: Brightspace, Blackboard, Turnitin, learning analytics, and online and blended delivery design.
- Approach: workflow mapping and automation; iterative user-feedback evaluation; Universal Design for Learning principles in curriculum design.

Professional Experience

Academic & Digital Lead: Enabling and Transition Courses

Charles Sturt University – Port Macquarie, NSW | 2022 – Present

- Led pilot implementation of Brightspace across enabling courses, which informed university-wide adoption.
- Designed AI-era assessment integrity frameworks in partnership with Academic Integrity and Compliance teams, balancing innovation, student learning, privacy, risk, and quality assurance.
- Identified business process improvement opportunities and introduced automation into recurring subject setup processes, significantly reducing workload allocation across 30+ subjects delivered six times per year.
- Drove capability uplift across 20+ academic and professional staff through training, guides, consultation, and practical adoption support.
- Advised Course Directors, School leadership, and university stakeholders up to Pro Vice-Chancellor level on AI strategy, governance, implementation risks, and scalable adoption models.

Founder – Quezzi (AI via SMS Platform)

Australia / International | 2025 – Present

- Architected an AI-powered conversational platform for low-connectivity contexts, integrating OpenAI and Google APIs and mobile service providers, including conditional routing, prompt frameworks, and conversation memory logic.
- Built evaluation frameworks measuring response quality, model performance, user engagement, and service reliability to drive iterative, data-informed improvement.
- Managed product strategy, analytics, marketing, subscription design, and financial modelling across AU, US, and Canada markets.

Acting Course Director: Enabling and Transition Courses

Charles Sturt University – Port Macquarie, NSW | Sep 2024, Sep 2025 & Mar 2026

- Managed operations for 20+ academic and professional staff, overseeing delivery, resourcing, and day-to-day decision-making.
- Represented the School in strategic projects involving student success, systems, and digital service redesign, engaging directly with institutional leadership.

Academic Project Manager – NPILF / Study Link

Charles Sturt University – Port Macquarie, NSW | 2024

- Led delivery of 10+ nationally funded Study Link digital capability subjects, including coding, cybersecurity and cyber ethics, designed to broaden STEM participation and support digital skills development in regional Australia.
- Coordinated cross-functional stakeholders across academic, professional, and external teams to align content development, enabling pedagogy, project milestones, and workforce-relevant digital capability outcomes.

- Supported inclusive curriculum design by embedding First Nations perspectives and equity-focused approaches into digital capability subjects.
- Led the introduction of Cogniti AI agents into Study Link subjects, piloting an ethically grounded and scalable approach to improving student engagement and learning interaction.

Lecturer / Associate Lecturer – Enabling Education and Philosophy

Charles Sturt University – Port Macquarie, NSW | 2013 – 2022

- Designed and delivered subjects across enabling education, academic literacies, ethics, logic, and critical reasoning, with a strong focus on equity, transition, and student success.
- Used student performance data, feedback, and learning analytics to improve learning design, engagement, and progression outcomes iteratively.

Governance and Institutional Service

Elected Member, Academic Senate

Charles Sturt University | 2026 – 2028 term

- Contribute to institutional governance and strategic academic decision-making.

School Assessment Committee Member (SAC)

School of Education – Charles Sturt University | 2023 – Present

- Provide governance oversight on assessment standards, moderation, quality assurance, and academic integrity, including AI-related risk and policy implementation considerations.

Education and Qualifications

Master of Arts: Professional and Applied Ethics (Honours) – Australian National University (2012).

Focus: Ethics of emerging technologies.

Postgraduate Certificate in Learning and Teaching in Higher Education – Charles Sturt University (2025).

Advanced Doctoral Research in Applied Ethics (3 years) – Charles Sturt University, Centre for Applied Philosophy and Public Ethics. Focus: Ethics of emerging technologies and responsible innovation.

Awards, Publications, and Professional Contributions

Awards

- Excellence Award Winner: Social Responsibility – Charles Sturt University, 2024.
- Provost Highly Commended Award – Charles Sturt University, 2021.

Conference Presentations

- Rodriguez, V. H. (2023). *A Pedagogical Approach to Fostering Critical Thinking*. CSU EDx
- Rodriguez, V. H. (2021). *A Good Approach to Giving Feedback (Video Feedback)*. CSU EDx.

Publications

- Weckert, J., Rodriguez, V. H., & Soltanzadeh, S. (2016). *A Problem with Societal Desirability as a Component of Responsible Research and Innovation: the "If we don't, somebody else will" Argument*. *NanoEthics*.
- Rodriguez, V. H. (2014). *Benefits Sharing*. In *Encyclopedia of Science, Technology and Ethics*. Cengage Gale.

*I developed this CV with the assistance of AI tools to enhance clarity and presentation.
All content is accurate and reflects genuine experience.*